

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 2

♥ J

♦ A 10 9 3 2

♣ A 5 4 3

♠ A 7 4

♥ A Q 8 5

♦ Q 7 4

♣ Q J 6



♠ Q J 10 6

♥ 10 9 6 3 2

♦ J 8

♣ K 8

♠ K 9 3

♥ K 7 4

♦ K 6 5

♣ 10 9 7 2

With 4-3-3-3 distribution and 15 points this hand qualifies for a 1NT opening. You bid 1NT and partner raises to 2NT.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid 3NT if you are at the top of your 15-17 point range. Since you have only 15 points you decline the invitation.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by North

Lead: ♠Q

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 3
 ♥ K 7 4
 ♦ Q J 8 5
 ♣ K 8 3

♠ 8 5 2

♥ J 10 8 2

♦ A K 9 6

♣ 7 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ A Q

♦ 10 7 4

♣ A Q 10 6 5

♠ K Q J 6

♥ 9 6 5 3

♦ 3 2

♣ J 9 2

This hand has 17 points and one of the balanced distributions. When you have a hand that meets the requirements you should open 1NT. Do not worry about the lack of a ♦ stopper, you don't have to have all the suits stopped to open 1NT. You bid 1NT and partner raises to 2NT.

You should count on partner for 9 points for his invitation. Your 17 brings the total to 26 so you bid 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠K

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 2
 ♥ 9 7 6 3
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ K 8 4

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ K 8 3



♠ 9 7 4 3
 ♥ J 10 5 2
 ♦ K 2
 ♣ 10 6 4

♠ Q J 10

♥ A Q

♦ 10 8 7

♣ A Q J 9 5

Of course you open 1NT. Partner responds 2NT.

With 15 points you decline invitations, and with 17 points you accept. But with 16 you have to use your judgement. Some players will just automatically bid 3NT when they have 16 points, preferring to err on the side of boldness than to possibly miss bidding a makeable game. Others prefer to base their decision on how good the hand looks.

With all the 10s and 9s this hand is stronger than 16 points, so you bid 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 3			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 10 5
 ♥ Q 9 8
 ♦ A Q 4
 ♣ A 9 8

♠ 6

♥ J 6 4 2

♦ K J 9 7 6 5

♣ J 3



♠ A K 3

♥ A K 7

♦ 10 8 2

♣ Q 10 7 5

♠ 9 8 7 4 2

♥ 10 5 3

♦ 3

♣ K 6 4 2

West

1NT

North

Pass

East

4NT

South

All Pass

4NT by West

Lead: ♥2

You open 1NT. Again. This time partner jumps to 4NT.

Partner's bid is **not** Blackwood. It is called a Quantitative 4NT and he is telling you he has a balanced 16-17 point hand. He is inviting you to bid 6NT.

With 17 you accept invitations, with 15 you decline. You have 15 so you pass.

As you see, there are 9 easy tricks and you can probably set up another. But you have no chance to make slam.